

THE HISTORY OF JAZZ IN 5 MINUTES (MELODIC IMPROVISATION, PART 2)

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #65

The Big Questions . . .

- Where did jazz improvisation come from?
- Who invented it? Was it “discovered,” or did it develop over time?

WHAT TO DO

- Pick a song you know WELL!
- Play a song many times through (like, 5 or 10 choruses).
- Play the first chorus EXACTLY as written, with NO embellishments.
- The 2nd chorus might have a handful of embellishments. A few changed rhythms. Maybe an added pitch or two. A trill, a bend. Not too many!
- The 10th chorus is pure embellishment. It’ll be hard to hear the melody.
- Each of the 8 choruses in between is a SLOW development from the preceding chorus.
- Each chorus is more “solo-like” than the previous, but still based ONLY on the melody.

WHAT NOT TO DO

- Don’t develop too fast. Your 3rd chorus (75 measures into a typical AABA song) is STILL mostly melody! Take your time.
- Don’t think about licks and harmonic devices and chord substitutions you know. Think about THE MELODY that you are playing.

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